

Marceau Air — HVAC Launch Plan (v2: Self-Funded Track)

Trade name (DBA): Marceau Air **Legal entity:** Marceau Solutions LLC (existing) **Domain:** marceausolutions.com — dedicated HVAC landing page at marceausolutions.com/air **Strategy: Self-funded.** Full-time HVAC build with parallel W-2 applications (no income dependency on landing a W-2). Dad operates as sole-proprietor contracting entity during bridge period; Marceau Solutions LLC takes over once DBPR qualifies it. **Created:** 2026-05-28 (supersedes pivot-plan.md dated 2026-05-25) **Target first paid service call:** Week of June 15, 2026 **Target Marceau Solutions LLC operational:** Week of July 13, 2026 **Target Aug 1 rent covered from HVAC revenue:** Required

What changed from v1

v1 (Path C — Hybrid)	v2 (Self-Funded)
W-2 lands by mid-July is the income strategy	No W-2 dependency — HVAC carries the cash flow
First service call eligible October 2026	First service call eligible mid-June 2026
DBPR Phase 2 filed Aug-Sept	DBPR Phase 2 filed this week (week of May 28)
Dad's role: Qualifying Agent only	Dad's role: Bridge sole-proprietor contractor (June), then Qualifying Agent for Marceau Solutions LLC (July+)
Insurance: pay annually for LLC	Insurance: single annual policy structured to cover the dad → LLC transition
AmEx minimums in cash flow	Removed (dispute resolved May 28)

Status snapshot (as of 2026-05-28)

Item	Status
Dad's HVAC license (CAC1814895)	Verified — Current, Active, Class A, expires 8/31/2026
Dad's commitment to qualify Marceau Solutions	Confirmed
Dad's training trip to Naples (replacing his own AC unit)	Confirmed — date TBD, target early-to-mid June

Dad's primary residence	New York (remote video supervision after training trip)
Marceau Solutions LLC	Existing, William sole owner
DBA "Marceau Air"	Confirmed
William's EPA 608 certification	NOT YET — scheduled May 30-31 weekend
William's health insurance	Highmark, covered through July 31, 2026
Cash on hand	\$5,000 savings
Chase Ink Business Cash	Active, 0% APR intro period (confirm expiration date)
AmEx FX dispute (case D-93497818/19)	Resolution by June 9, 2026 — \$2,441.76 upside if it lands
Auto insurance for business use	Must update before first paid job
GL insurance	NOT YET — 3 broker quotes due by Friday June 5
Marceau Solutions DBPR qualification	NOT YET — CILB 4357 to be filed this week

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Strategic premises

1. **HVAC is now primary income, not secondary.** Every operational decision optimizes for revenue speed.
2. **W-2 applications continue in parallel.** Applying for I&E/SCADA roles takes ~2 hours/week and does not reduce HVAC time. A W-2 landing would be upside, not the plan.
3. **The dad-as-bridge structure is short** (~6 weeks). Goal is to compress the gap between "first paying customer" and "Marceau Solutions LLC contracts in its own name" as much as possible.
4. **Remote QA supervision after the training trip is documented and defensible.** Florida DBPR requires the Qualifying Agent to "primarily exercise management or supervisory functions" — this is achievable via documented video walkthroughs, recorded job review calls, signed-off quotes, and pulled-permit signatures. The plan builds in the supervision evidence trail from day one.
5. **Scope is tiered to William's skill ramp.** Start with Tier-1 service work (diagnostic, capacitor, contactor, refrigerant top-off, drain line) — the work that does not require senior judgment on site. Tier 2 and 3 work after demonstrated competence with documented video review.

Phase 0: This week (May 28 — June 1)

#	Item	Owner	By date
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0.1	EPA 608 Universal Certification — study + test	William	Sun May 31
0.2	Call 3 contractor-specialty insurance brokers with the named transition question (Hiscox, Federated, local Naples agent). Get written quotes.	William	Fri Jun 5
0.3	Verify Chase Ink Business Cash 0% APR expiration date — confirm intro window length	William	Fri May 29
0.4	Update SUV auto insurance with commercial-use rider	William	Wed Jun 3
0.5	Confirm dad's training-trip dates (Naples AC replacement)	William	Mon Jun 1
0.6	File for Federal EIN for dad's sole proprietorship (15-min IRS.gov form)	Dad (or William assisting)	Mon Jun 1
0.7	File DBPR Form CILB 4357 — Qualifying Business Application for Marceau Solutions LLC. Online, \$155.	William	Fri Jun 5
0.8	File FL Division of Workers Comp exemption for William as sole operator of Marceau Solutions	William	Fri Jun 5
0.9	Register "Marceau Air" DBA with Collier County (if not already done) — \$50	William	Wed Jun 3
0.10	Order magnetic SUV signs (12×18 pair, \$50-100) — "Marceau Air Heating & Cooling (239) 398-5676 CAC1814895"	William	Mon Jun 1
0.11	Open dedicated business checking account for dad's sole prop activity (separate from personal)	Dad / William	Wed Jun 3
0.12	Draft 1099 contractor agreement between dad's sole prop and William for HVAC labor (rate + scope)	William	Mon Jun 1

Estimated Phase 0 cost: \$400-\$600 (608 test, DBA filing, CILB 4357 fee, magnetic signs).

Phase 1: Dad's training trip + first jobs (June 1 — July 12)

Week 1-2: Training trip (target: early June)

Dad flies down for ~5-7 days. Primary purpose: replace the AC unit at his Naples property with William executing under dad's direct on-site supervision. Secondary purpose: hands-on training across the full

Training trip checklist:

- [] Replace dad's Naples AC unit (full install — refrigerant pull-down, evacuation, new unit set, line set, electrical, charge, startup, customer documentation)

• [] Tier-1 skills practice: capacitor swap, contactor swap, refrigerant gauge reading, leak detection, drain line clearing, blower motor diagnostics	
• [] Tool inventory completed against the master list in the original pivot-plan.md (what dad has vs. what William needs to buy)	
• [] Customer interaction script practice (greeting, diagnostic walkthrough, quote presentation, payment handling)	
• [] First 1-2 paying service calls performed <i>during</i> the training trip with dad physically present (warm referrals from dad's old Naples contacts ideally)	
• [] Video supervision protocol established: format, frequency, what gets recorded, where it's stored	
• [] Dad signs paperwork to enable William to act as authorized helper / 1099 contractor under his sole-prop	

Weeks 3-6 (post-training): Solo Tier-1 jobs

After dad departs, William operates solo on Tier-1 work with remote video supervision. Marketing engine spins up in parallel.

Item	Notes
Daily job execution	Target 2-4 service calls/day by week 4. Tier 1 only (see scope matrix below).
Video supervision before each new-type job	William sends 60-90 second video walkthrough to dad describing the job. Dad approves or asks questions before William commits to a quote.
Video supervision after each job	William sends short close-out video documenting work performed. Filed by date in shared Google Drive folder.
Weekly review call with dad	30-min Zoom each Sunday. Review the week's jobs, lessons, customer feedback.
Customer communications	All quotes/invoices issued under dad's sole-prop name (e.g., "William Marceau Sr. — Marceau Air, License #CAC1814895"). Phone (239) 398-5676 routed to William.
Lead generation	Friend's FB ads training tactics + Nextdoor + Google Business Profile + flyers in 3 target zip codes
Hours tracking	William logs every job hour in shared sheet. Counts toward his own future Class A license (4-year requirement).

Phase 1 revenue model (conservative)

Week	Service calls	Avg ticket	Gross	William's take (after dad's share)
Wk 1 (training trip)	2-3	\$300	\$600-\$900	William paid hourly during training (~\$25/hr × ~30 hrs = \$750)

Wk 2-3	4-6 ea	\$300	\$1,200- \$1,800 ea	\$600-\$900 each week
Wk 4-5	8-12 ea	\$300	\$2,400- \$3,600 ea	\$1,200-\$1,800 each week
Wk 6	10-15	\$300	\$3,000- \$4,500	\$1,500-\$2,250

June revenue (William's net): \$5,000-\$8,000. This covers monthly living + ad spend + leaves \$2-4k toward the Aug 1 rent reserve.

(Dad's share covers his time during the training trip, GL insurance premium, materials handling on his books, and the use of his license for the bridge period. Specific split to be negotiated — placeholder: 40% to dad, 60% to William after direct job costs. Update once dad-conversation completes.)

[REDACTED]

Application status timeline

Date	Event
Fri Jun 5	CILB 4357 filed online with DBPR
Jun 6-19	DBPR initial completeness review (~10 business days)
Jun 19 - Jul 3	Board review queue (next FL CILB meeting falls in this window)
Wk of Jul 7-14	Approval expected (assumes no deficiencies — clean filing)
Wk of Jul 14	Marceau Solutions LLC begins operating as the contracting entity
Aug 31, 2026	Dad's CAC1814895 renewal deadline. Dad completes CEU hours + \$255 renewal fee. License extended to 8/31/2028. Marceau Solutions QA status continues uninterrupted.

What changes at transition

- All new customer contracts in Marceau Solutions LLC's name
- All revenue flows to Marceau Solutions business checking
- GL insurance endorsement / additional named insured activates LLC coverage (see Insurance section)
- Dad's sole-prpp bank account is closed once final reconciliations complete
- Dad transitions from bridge contractor to Qualifying Agent — paperwork-only role, no revenue split going forward
- William's hours continue to accrue toward his own future license

Dad's supervision structure (remote QA defensibility)

Florida DBPR enforcement against absentee QAs has historically targeted "license rental" arrangements with zero involvement. The defense against any future audit is **documented active supervision**. This plan creates that evidence trail:

Supervision mechanism	Frequency	Evidence stored
Training trip (initial in-person)	1× at launch (June)	Photos, video, signed training-completion checklist
Pre-job video walkthrough	Before any new job type	Video file in Google Drive, dated, indexed by customer + job #
Post-job close-out video	After every job	Same Drive folder
Weekly review Zoom	Every Sunday	Calendar invite, recorded call optional
Permit signatures	As required	Notarized signatures (FL permits typically allow mailed/ scanned QA signatures for AC change-outs)
Quote approval	Every quote over \$1,000	Dad approves via email or signed text confirmation before quote goes to customer
Quarterly in-person visit (target)	4× per year minimum	Travel logs

Backup plan if DBPR challenges supervision: Documented evidence above + dad's flight records for in-person visits + recorded review calls. Florida case law (e.g., *Cardenas v. DBPR*) suggests QAs who maintain demonstrable supervision routines — even remotely — are defensible against "license front" findings.

Job-scope discipline: Until William earns his own Class A license (4-year experience requirement), no work is taken on that exceeds the supervision-via-video model. See Tiered Service Scope below.

Tiered service scope (William's skill ramp)

Start narrow, expand only after demonstrated competence. Pricing stays competitive within the SW FL				
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Tier 1 — Available from Day 1 post-training (June 15+)

- Diagnostic service call (\$89-\$129 trip charge) - Capacitor replacement (\$250-\$450)				
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• Contactor replacement (\$200-\$350)		
• Refrigerant top-off (\$150-\$350/lb)		
• Drain line clearing (\$100-\$200)		
• Coil cleaning (\$150-\$300)		
• Air filter service / maintenance plan visits (\$60-\$150)		
• Blower motor capacitor diagnostic / replacement		

• Float switch replacement		
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Target volume: 2-4 calls/day by week 4. **Daily revenue ceiling:** \$400-\$1,200.

Tier 2 — Unlocked after ~30 days + ~20 Tier-1 jobs completed + dad video-approval

• Condenser fan motor replacement (\$400-\$650)		
• Blower motor replacement		

• Refrigerant leak detection + minor repair (line set joints, schrader cores)		
• Evaporator coil cleaning (full pull)		
• Full system refrigerant recovery / recharge		

Tier 3 — Unlocked after ~90 days + dad video-approval

• Compressor replacement (\$1,500-\$3,500)		
• Full system replacement / new install (\$5,000-\$8,500)		
• Light commercial service		
• Ductwork modifications		
• Heat pump diagnostics + repair		

Permanently outside scope without dad on-site

• Major commercial work		
• Cooling tower / chiller work		
• Refrigerant retrofits (R-22 → R-410A or R-32)		
• Anything requiring a Class B-only specialty if a question arises		

Capital plan		

Total launch capital required: \$4,500 - \$7,500

Funding sources

Source	Use	Amount
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Cash on hand (\$5,000 savings)	Aug 1 rent (\$1,687) + living buffer (\$2,000) + emergency reserve (\$1,313)	Hold in checking; don't spend down for business
Chase Ink Business Cash 0% APR	GL insurance annual premium, tool gap-fill, refrigerant + recovery tank, FB ads, EPA 608 cert, DBA filing, CILB 4357	\$3,500-\$6,500
June HVAC revenue (William's net)	Living expenses + materials reorder + paying down Chase Ink balance	\$5,000-\$8,000
AmEx FX shortfall (potential)	If credited June 9, allocate \$2,441 to Chase Ink paydown	\$0 - \$2,441

What goes on Chase Ink 0%

Item	Cost
GL insurance — annual premium (single policy, dad-to-LLC structure)	\$1,500-\$3,000
Tool gap-fill (refrigerant gauges, recovery machine if dad doesn't have one, hand tools)	\$500-\$1,500
Initial refrigerant inventory + recovery tank	\$400-\$800
FB ads budget (first 90 days at \$20-50/day)	\$1,000-\$1,500
Software subscriptions (Housecall Pro or Jobber, \$59-\$129/mo × 3 mo)	\$200-\$400
Auto insurance commercial rider	\$200-\$500
EPA 608 test + study materials	\$50
Marceau Air landing page + Google Workspace (already paid)	\$0
Magnetic signs + business cards + polo shirts	\$250-\$500

Total Chase Ink charge: ~\$4,100-\$8,250.

Pay-off plan: Direct 60-80% of weekly HVAC revenue to Chase Ink balance until cleared. Target: zero balance by **August 31, 2026** (well before any reasonable 0% expiration). Confirm exact 0% end date and set a calendar alert 30 days before.

What stays in cash (do NOT charge on credit)

• Rent (Bonita Springs apartment, due Aug 1) — pay from checking			
• Utilities, groceries, gas, personal living			
• Health insurance (Highmark covered through Jul 31; ACA from Aug 1 — line item below)			
• Emergency / unexpected (car repair, dystonia-related medical, etc.)			

90-day cash flow projection

Income (William's net)

Month	HVAC net	W-2 (if landed)	Other	Total
June	\$5,000-\$8,000	\$0 (assumed)	\$0	\$5,000-\$8,000
July	\$7,000-\$12,000 (mid-month LLC transition adds margin)	\$0	\$2,441 if AmEx resolves	\$7,000-\$14,500
August	\$9,000-\$15,000 (full LLC, repeat customers, maintenance plan signups)	\$0	\$0	\$9,000-\$15,000
3-month total (William's net)	\$21,000-\$35,000	—	—	\$21,000-\$37,500

Outflows

Category	Monthly	Notes
Rent (Bonita Springs)	\$1,687	First payment due Aug 1
Utilities + internet + phone	~\$250	Apartment + business line
Health insurance	\$0 (Jun-Jul on Highmark); \$200-\$400 (Aug+)	ACA marketplace from Aug 1 (revisit closer to date)
Food / personal	~\$500	Groceries, household
Gas / vehicle	~\$300	Higher with HVAC service driving
Chase Ink minimum payment	\$25-\$100	Aggressive paydown above min
Software / subscriptions	~\$200	CRM, Marceau Solutions ops, accounting
Marketing (FB ads etc.)	~\$500-\$1,000	Tracked separately as business expense
Monthly total	~\$3,500 (Jun-Jul) / ~\$4,500 (Aug+)	

Net position end of 90 days

Conservative: \$21,000 net income – \$13,000 outflows = **+\$8,000 net cash**, Chase Ink balance: \$0-\$2,000 remaining.

Optimistic: \$37,500 net income – \$13,500 outflows = **+\$24,000 net cash**, Chase Ink balance: \$0, working capital pool building for tool upgrades + first hire.

Insurance structure (single annual policy, dad→LLC transition)

See gap-resolution notes above. Required actions:

1. Call 3 contractor-specialty brokers by Friday Jun 5:

- Hiscox (online, fast)
- Federated Insurance (contractor focus)
- Local Naples independent agent (ask dad for referrals from his network)

2. Question to ask every broker:

"We're filing CILB 4357 next week. My father holds CAC1814895 and will be the qualifying agent for Marceau Solutions LLC. DBPR approval expected mid-July. He operates as the contracting party in his individual name from now until DBPR approval, then Marceau Solutions LLC takes over. What's the cleanest single-policy structure that covers both phases without us paying two annual premiums?"

schedule, effective from date of issuance. Coverage applies whether contracts are signed in dad's name or LLC's name during the bridge.

4. Backup structure if (3) unavailable: Policy in dad's name with mid-term endorsement to swap named insured to LLC when DBPR approves (~\$25-100 endorsement fee).

5. Coverage minimums (Class A):

- \$300k Bodily Injury / \$50k Property Damage minimum (FL Class A requirement)
- Recommended: \$1M / \$1M combined single limit
- \$1M aggregate

6. Cost ceiling: \$3,000/year. If quotes exceed, revisit broker selection — that's high for a single-tech FL HVAC sole prop.

Marketing — front-loaded for cash speed

The plan needs revenue from week 2 onward. Marketing budget is allocated for fast converting channels first.

Week 1 (during training trip)

- Warm referrals: dad calls 3-5 old Naples contacts to seed first customers

- Phone (239) 398-5676 confirmed routing to William
- Business cards printed (handed out during training trip)

Week 2-4

Springs, Estero homeowners 35-65
• Nextdoor business profile (free, strong local signal) • Door hangers in 3 target neighborhoods (200-500 hangers, \$50-100) • Yelp business listing (free tier)
• Google Local Service Ads (LSA) — only available after license + insurance + background check verified. Apply Week 4.

Week 5+

• Customer review collection (text after each job with Google review link) • Referral incentive: \$25 credit for referrer, \$25 off for new customer • Maintenance plan upsell to every Tier-1 service customer (\$129-\$249/yr) • Adjust FB ad targeting based on which ads convert
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Marketing budget — first 90 days

Channel	Spend
FB ads	\$1,000-\$1,500
Door hangers	\$100-\$200
Business cards + magnetic signs	\$250-\$500
Google LSA (week 4 onward)	\$300-\$600/mo
Review platform fees	\$0 (Yelp/Google free; Nextdoor free)
Total	\$1,650-\$2,800

Risk + mitigation (updated for no-W-2 track)

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
DBPR delays CILB 4357 approval past mid-July	Medium	High — extends bridge period	Submit perfectly the first time, no deficiencies. Follow up weekly. Pay for permit-expediter consultation if 6 weeks pass with no decision.
Dad's training trip slips into July	Low	High — pushes first-job date	Lock dates by June 1. Buy his flight if needed. Trip is non-optional.

GL insurance cannot be structured for single policy	Low	Medium (\$1,500-\$3,000 hit)	Plan accommodates double-pay scenario — Chase Ink absorbs it.
First-month service calls don't materialize	Medium	High — cash crisis	Marketing budget front-loaded. Dad's warm referrals + door hangers + Google Business Profile activate week 1, FB ads ramp week 2. Pivot to higher ad spend if needed.
AmEx FX dispute denied	Low (high-leverage case)	Low (+\$2,441 is upside, not baseline)	Plan does NOT depend on this money. CFPB filed June 10 if denied.
Hurricane disrupts work (Jun-Nov)	Medium (annual FL risk)	Medium — hurts install side, helps emergency repair side	Focus on service calls during storm season — emergency repair demand spikes. Reschedule any planned install jobs.
Customer complaint triggers DBPR investigation of remote supervision	Low	High if it lands	Documented video supervision evidence trail (see Supervision section). Limit job scope to Tier 1 until skill demonstrated.
Chase Ink 0% expires before balance cleared	Low if tracked	Medium (interest accrual)	Calendar alert 30 days before expiration. Pay-off plan front-loads HVAC revenue against the balance.
Health insurance gap (Aug 1+) costs more than expected	Medium	Low-medium	Apply ACA marketplace by July 15. Budget \$200-\$400/mo as line item; subsidies likely substantial given W-2 absence.
William's dystonia limits days worked	Existing condition	Medium	Built into schedule: max 5 days/wk active service, weekend recovery. Tier-1 scope keeps individual jobs short (1-2 hrs typical).
Auto accident on a job without commercial rider	Low if rider added	High (claim denial)	Rider added Phase 0. Non-negotiable before first paid job.

Open conversations / items William needs to lock down

#	Item	Who	By date
1	Dad — split percentage (40/60? 50/50? hourly during training?)	Dad ↔ William	Sun Jun 1

2	Dad — training trip dates locked	Dad ↔ William	Sun Jun 1
3	Dad — EIN + business bank account setup process	Dad (William assists)	Wed Jun 3
4	Dad — comfort with named-contractor role for ~6 weeks	Dad ↔ William	Already done — confirm in writing
5	Friend's FB ads training — did it happen (Tue May 26)? What was learned?	William	Note before Phase 1
6	Chase Ink — confirm 0% APR expiration date	William	Fri May 29
7	Health insurance ACA quotes — gather options for Aug 1 enrollment	William	Mid-July
8	Job-hours tracking system (per FL DBPR future-license requirement)	William	Mon Jun 1

Trigger	Action
Week 4: HVAC net revenue < \$1,500/week	Re-evaluate marketing mix. Increase FB ad spend or hire local marketing consultant.
Week 6: DBPR still hasn't approved CILB 4357	Call DBPR for status; consider expediter consultation.
Week 8: HVAC net revenue still < \$2,500/week	Consider taking a W-2 if a strong offer lands AND HVAC can be reduced to ~25 hrs/week.
Week 12: HVAC net revenue > \$4,000/week consistently	Begin hiring a helper / second tech. Consider dedicated service van. Update vinyl-vs-magnetic decision (per v1 plan).
Any time: Chase Ink balance > \$7,500	Pause non-essential spending until paid down to \$5,000.
Any time: Cash savings < \$2,000	Halt all discretionary spend. Pivot to highest-margin job types only.

Brand + identity

• Customer-facing name:	Marceau Air		
• Legal name (post-transition):	Marceau Solutions LLC dba Marceau Air		
• Legal name (June bridge):	William Marceau Sr. dba Marceau Air (license #CAC1814895)		

- **Phone:** (239) 398-5676
- **Email:** wmarceau@marceausolutions.com
- **Web:** marceausolutions.com/air
- **Brand colors:** Gold #C9963C / Charcoal #333333 (NEVER green)
- **Tagline candidate:** "Three Generations of Naples Air Conditioning Expertise — Family-Owned, Florida-Licensed"

Summary

This plan delivers:

- First HVAC revenue **within ~2 weeks** of dad's training trip (target mid-June)
- Marceau Solutions LLC operational as the contracting entity by **mid-July**
- Aug 1 rent paid from HVAC revenue + savings buffer intact
- Chase Ink 0% balance retired by Aug 31
- Year-1 trajectory toward \$80k-\$150k revenue / \$30k-\$60k net to William
- William's hours-under-license tracking from day 1 toward his own future Class A

The plan's load-bearing assumptions are: (1) dad's training trip happens in early to mid-June, (2) DBPR approves CILB 4357 by mid-July, (3) marketing converts well enough for 8-12 service calls/week by week 4, and (4) GL insurance can be structured for single annual policy. If any of those slip, the decision triggers and risk-mitigation playbook above absorb the impact without breaking the plan.

Plan created May 28, 2026 — supersedes pivot-plan.md (dated 2026-05-25). Companion document: qualifying-agent-risk-analysis.md.